

Career Decision-Making Council

Prompt + Outcome

PROMPT

You are an independent expert on a decision-making council.

Decision: Which career role should I focus on for my upcoming placements?

Background: I am a 3rd-year Computer Science Engineering student preparing for placements. I have experience with Java, Python, SQL, machine learning and a full-stack project. I want to choose a career direction where my current skills give me the best opportunity.

Evidence: My attached resume.

Evaluate the decision independently. Do not assume that other council members agree with you.

Provide your response in this format:

1. Recommended decision
 2. Three strongest reasons supporting your recommendation
 3. Three major risks or disadvantages
 4. Assumptions your recommendation depends on
 5. Important information that is still missing
 6. One simple, low-cost way to test the decision
 7. Confidence score from 0-100, with a short explanation
- Be objective and point out weaknesses in the available evidence.

OUTCOME

1. Recommended decision

Do not target Software Developer or Full-Stack roles as the primary path. Instead, focus placement preparation on Data Analyst / ML Engineer (entry-level) roles, using Python, SQL and the CMAC machine learning project as the core differentiators, while treating general software development as a fallback.

2. Three strongest reasons supporting the recommendation

- 1 The combination of Python, SQL and a completed machine learning project (CMAC: preprocessing, model training, evaluation) is a distinctive profile compared to peers who only list generic web-development skills.
- 2 SQL skills (joins, aggregate functions) map directly onto data-analyst interview screens, which frequently test exactly this kind of querying ability.
- 3 Entry-level data/ML-adjacent roles often weight problem framing and analytical reasoning over deep software-engineering polish, which plays to the resume's strengths better than a pure SDE track would.

3. Three major risks or disadvantages

- 1 The resume states the ML work was completed under senior guidance, so the candidate cannot yet claim independent ownership of the ML pipeline, which is a real gap versus other ML-track applicants.
- 2 Entry-level ML/Data roles are comparatively scarce at many campus drives compared to generalist SDE openings, which could shrink the pool of applicable positions.
- 3 Without a portfolio of additional data projects or competition results (e.g., Kaggle), the single ML project may not be sufficient to pass a specialized technical screen.

4. Assumptions the recommendation depends on

- Campus placement drives actually include dedicated data-analyst or ML-associate openings, not only generalist SDE roles.
- The candidate is willing to independently extend the CMAC project (e.g., new features, better evaluation metrics) to demonstrate ownership.
- The candidate can speak fluently to statistics and ML fundamentals in interviews, not just the tools used.
- There is enough runway before placements to build 1-2 additional independent data projects.

5. Important information that is still missing

- The exact scope of the candidate's individual contribution to the CMAC project versus the senior mentor's contribution.
- Any statistics/ML coursework or certifications beyond the one project.
- Whether target companies' placement drives include data/ML-specific roles this year.
- Any independent data projects, Kaggle participation, or research work.
- The candidate's actual interest level in data/ML work versus general software development.

6. One simple, low-cost way to test the decision

Pick one public dataset unrelated to CMAC and independently build a small end-to-end analysis or model in two weeks, then write up the approach and results. Being able to justify every step without mentor input would be a strong signal this direction is viable.

7. Confidence score

58/100. Confidence is moderate-to-low: the evidence for an independent ML/data skill set is thin (one mentor-assisted project), and there is no information confirming that data/ML roles are actually offered in the candidate's placement drives, which is a major open risk for this recommendation.

Council conclusion

A data/ML-adjacent path is plausible but currently the least evidenced of the three options. It should only be pursued in parallel with, not instead of, a general software-development fallback, until independent ML work is demonstrated.